

Lee-Ann Vidal-Covas | PhD

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About me

Language Scientist with 10+ years of experience in linguistic research, data curation, and applied data science. Proven ability to manage projects, collaborate cross-functionally, and communicate complex findings to diverse audiences.

Skills

Data Science & Research

QA
Statistical analysis
Experiment design
Workflow automation
Data creation, cleaning & sampling
Data processing & visualization

Project Management

Problem-solving
Strategic thinking
Event coordination
Stakeholder communication
Interdisciplinary collaboration
Long-term team management

Annotation

Data labeling
Guideline creation
Linguistic data analysis

Tech Tools

R	•••••	LaTeX	•••••
GitHub	•••••	HTML	•••••
Python	•••••	regex	•••••

Languages

Native	English, Spanish
Elementary	Brazilian Portuguese
Fieldwork	Indonesian, Wichita, West Greenlandic, Yagua, Zulu

Education

2025 Ph.D., Linguistics, Boston University
2021 M.A., Linguistics, Boston University
2013 M.A., Hispanic Studies & Ling., LSU
2011 B.A., Hispanic Studies & Lit., LSU

Research

Published in peer-reviewed venues; presented at international conferences. See [Academic CV](#) or [website](#) for full list.

References

Available [here](#).

Experience

Cogito Corporation

2022 – 2023 **Data Annotator | Machine Learning Annotation**

- Produced high-quality annotated speech datasets to support ML model training.
- Labeled conversational audio (*engagement, energy, pace*), boosting model calibration.
- Evaluated pre-trained models & provided actionable feedback, boosting accuracy.
- Suggested workflow improvements, reducing annotation turnaround time.

Boston University

2018 – 2025 **Doctoral Researcher | Project & Lab Manager**

- Trained 10+ student researchers and developed reusable R & Praat workflows that automated dataset updates, reduced manual processing, and improved data quality & workflow consistency across multiple speech datasets.
- Led all aspects of a multi-year research project on covariation & salience in linguistic contact; developed [annotation guidelines](#) to label the data for 12 properties and built [reproducible R pipelines](#) to clean & analyze 20k+ data points with mixed-effects modeling, resulting in 1 monograph, 1 paper, and 8 presentations.
- Developed and implemented an online experimental study on word order preference in Spanish; recruited participants via Prolific, hosted the study in Qualtrics, wrote [design documents & guidelines](#), and analyzed results using linear & logistic mixed-effects models in R, resulting in 1 paper & 2 presentations.
- Co-organized conference (~1,000 participants), successfully transitioning the international event to virtual format during COVID-19. Oversaw talk selection & programming. Supported publication of proceedings.

St. Joseph's Academy & Academy of the Sacred Heart

2014 – 2018 **Secondary Spanish & Technology Educator**

- Developed and taught multiple Spanish courses; designed curricula, lecture notes, assignments, and assessments for >1000 enrolled students.
- Automated assessments by coding self-grading grammar quizzes, improving feedback speed & freeing class time for project-based learning.
- Designed & delivered a middle school digital literacy curriculum, training students in productivity tools, safe online practices, & collaborative workflows.
- Implemented onboarding workshops for 250+ incoming high school students per year, guiding digital setup & proficiency in Microsoft Office & school platforms.
- Planned & led multiple international immersion programs for 40+ students, ensuring safety, cultural exchange, & logistical coordination.
- Organized statewide Spanish conferences with 200+ participants annually, raising interest in Spanish learning across Louisiana schools.
- Full teaching record available on [website](#) | [Academic CV](#).

Louisiana State University

2012 – 2013 **Graduate Researcher | Project Manager | Spanish Instructor**

- Conducted semi-structured interviews with native speakers of Spanish to study pronoun use; resulting in 1 paper & 8 presentations.
- Developed and taught multiple courses in Spanish; designed curricula, lecture notes, assignments, and assessments for >500 enrolled students.

Communications on Hold

2007 – 2017 **Administrative Coordinator | Office & Production Manager**

- Managed office operations, finances, and client workflows, ensuring efficient project delivery while cutting turnaround time and boosting client retention.